action was named Operation Polo, supposedly because of the large number of polo grounds in Hyderabad.

The Indian army columns entered Hyderabad state on 13 September and were met with some resistance from the Razakdars as well as from regular troops. However, the result was never in doubt and, by the morning of 17 September, it was all over. The surrender was surprisingly meek. *Time* magazine (issue of 27 September 1948) tells the story of how the surrender took place a few miles outside the city. The commander-in-chief of Hyderabad's army, a black-mustached Arab called Major General Syed Ahmed El Erdoos drove up in a shiny Buick. He then walked up to Major General Chaudhuri, the Indian field commander. 'They shook hands, lit cigarettes and talked quietly while the spellbound villagers looked on'.[4]

The story of Jammu and Kashmir, however, is very different. Here a Hindu prince ruled over a Muslim-majority kingdom. However, the overall Muslim majority obscured a more complicated situation on the ground. The north-east of the state was Ladakh, a large but sparsely populated area dominated by Buddhists. To the north-west were the equally sparsely populated areas of Gilgit and Baltistan. The population here was Muslim but from the Shia and Ismaili sects rather than the Sunni branch. In the middle was Kashmir itself, including the Valley, relatively densely populated and largely Sunni, albeit with significant Sikh, Hindu and Shia minorities. Finally, to the south was Jammu, home to the Dogra Rajputs who had conquered this kingdom, with a Hindu population boosted by recent refugees from West Punjab. Unlike Junagarh and Hyderabad, moreover, this state shared borders with both India and Pakistan. This meant that it was feasible for it to choose sides. Yet, Maharaja Hari Singh had visions of remaining independent as some sort of Asian Switzerland. The situation could not have been more complex.

One will never know how things may have eventually resolved themselves because the flow of history was hijacked by an unexpected turn of events. On 22 October 1947, thousands of armed Pakhtun tribesmen from Pakistan's North West poured into Kashmir. No one knows for sure exactly who organized or instigated them, although they certainly had the